

Engaged Learning Rubric

EC325: Econometrics | Colby College

Prof. Caraher

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Engaged learning is 5% of your grade, scored 0–5 (one point per level). You will get a **provisional score after the midterm**—feedback only, no weight. Your **final score replaces it rather than averaging with it**: at a 2 in October and a 4 in December, you earn the 4.

Score	What it looks like
5	Visible in more than one way, all semester. Regularly asks or answers questions that move class forward, including when unsure, and brings prepared questions to office hours. The person the group relies on to keep the project moving. Explains material to classmates in a way that leaves them able to do it themselves. Attendance essentially perfect.
4	Reliably engaged. Contributes in class most weeks, or just as consistently through another channel—office hours, in-class group work, questions by email. Meets group commitments on time and answers teammates. Absences communicated in advance.
3	Present and participating at a basic level. Contributes sometimes but not dependably; more often responds when called on than volunteers. Does assigned group tasks without coordinating anyone else's; seeks help late, or not at all. A few uncommunicated absences.
2	Attends but largely passive. Little voluntary contribution anywhere I can see it, and no office hours. Group work done to the minimum, sometimes late; peer review notes gaps. Several unexcused absences.
1	Attends inconsistently and disengages when present. Group members report covering work that was yours. No help-seeking even after being encouraged. Repeated unexcused absences.
0	Effectively no participation. Chronic unexcused absence, no contribution in class or to the group, unresponsive to outreach.

What the score is built from

- Questions asked and answered in class, and contributions during in-class group work (I note these after each session).
- Office hours visits, appointments, and substantive questions by email.
- Your group's progress at the five project checkpoints, and how much of it depended on you.
- The end-of-semester peer review, which asks about each member's contribution including your own.
- Attendance. Unexcused absences—anything other than a pre-notified conflict or illness—count against it.

Three things worth being clear about

- **Speaking in class is not the only path to a 5.** What separates a 4 from a 2 is not volume but whether there is *evidence* you are working on this material somewhere I can see it. A student who never volunteers but comes to office hours every other week with real questions is a 4 or a 5.
- **Being wrong out loud is worth points.** An attempted answer that turns out to be wrong is a contribution and is scored as one. The only thing that scores badly is silence that hides confusion until the exam.
- **Moving up a level is cheaper than it looks.** One prepared question in office hours per week, or one attempted answer per class, moves most students from a 3 to a 4 over a semester. Reaching a 5 takes something the course would not otherwise get: steadying a drifting group, explaining a method to classmates who then use it correctly, asking a question that reframes the discussion. If you are unsure where you stand, ask me—I would much rather tell you in week 6 than in December.